Evgenii Zaitsev

Product Manager · B2B and B2C

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Saint Petersburg · Russian / English · Technical background

PMP (PMI, 2023) · Certified ScrumMaster (CSM, 2023) · HSE: Master in Management, professional education with distinction

Product Manager with an engineering background and B2B/B2C experience. I connect research, strategy and teamwork. EmTalk founder, from customer discovery to released apps. Team results: LTV +20% at Kickidler; time-to-market from 1.5 months to 2 weeks at Samolet. Metrics are provided by the author.

Experience & responsibility

Samolet | Apr 2026 - present

Product Manager · Internal CRM products

Work on sales CRM conversion; forecast economic impact of the initiatives: approximately RUB 500 million. With the team, reduced TTM from 1.5 months to 2 weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. Built a Python/Streamlit and ClickHouse analytics product.

• Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify blockers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes.

EmTalk | Feb 2023 - present

Founder / Product Owner

50+ customer discovery interviews; released BRET and Decision Matrix on Google Play with the team. Added guest web flows without installation or registration. Lead product strategy, priorities and team AI tools.

• Responsible for product strategy, development and first users; lead discovery, roadmap and prioritization.

Freelance / Project engagements | Jun 2023 - Apr 2026

Project / Product Manager

Kickidler: LTV grew by 20%, TTM halved (self-reported); diagnosis, roadmap and analytics. WinLab: Senior Project Manager (outstaff), assortment, checkout and 1C reporting.

• WinLab: with the team, moved the assortment project to business and functional requirements; secured contractor priority for the checkout project. 1C reporting reached a test launch before I left.

Statistics & Control / Statcontrol | Jul 2019 - Feb 2023

Technical Product Owner / Project Manager

Managed projects with a combined value of approximately RUB 50 million per year. OptiRamp: discovery and digital twins. Honeywell DCS: migration automation in a four-person team.

• Worked with Russian and international clients from presales and problem discovery through OptiRamp implementation and testing.

Gazprom avtomatizatsia | Oct 2017 - Jul 2019

Team Leader

Control systems for gas turbines and gas transport facilities. Engineering and on-site team leadership, including assignments beyond the Arctic Circle.

• Developed control software; contributed to commissioning, FAT and SAT.

Product stories

Samolet: from user friction to faster delivery

Two CRM products, a newly assembled team and low adoption. I started with discovery and priority fixes, then changed requirements, early QA involvement and analytics.

Context and priorities

Joined a new team responsible for two CRM products with low usage. Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify barriers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes. Work on conversion; the initiatives have a forecast economic impact of approximately RUB 500 million. This is a forecast, not realised revenue.

Requirements, quality and data

Designed an ICONIX-based approach: user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams reviewed before development. With the team, involved QA earlier and used human-reviewed AI-generated test cases and SDD. With no analyst on the team, built an AI-assisted Python/Streamlit product for ClickHouse dashboards and analysis. The incoming analyst adopted the approach; the product remains in use.

Team results

Reduced TTM from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. My contribution: priorities, requirements, early QA involvement and stakeholder alignment. Adoption still needs improvement; delivery outcomes do not establish demand growth.

Behavioural marketing and sales flow

In a joint manager-panel concept, connected the customer's situation, clarifying questions, relevant material and a next step. Storynomics and behavioural design informed the flow. The concept was presented to directors and moved into refinement. Proposed a pilot with a comparison group; execution and conversion gains are not yet confirmed.

Discovery and delivery | Sales-flow concept

EmTalk: products and first value in the browser

From customer discovery and a team without initial funding to released apps, guest web flows and ecosystem development.

Research, strategy and team

Conducted 50+ customer discovery interviews, researched the market and competitors, and built a team without initial funding. Responsible for strategy, roadmap, priorities and first users. With the team, moved from a super-app concept to connected directions: well-being, self-understanding, decisions and skills development.

From discovery to products

Released BRET and Decision Matrix on Google Play with the team; tests and articles are available on the website. BRET supports well-being practices; DM helps compare options. TAPL continues to develop as an EdTech product after pivots; no public release is claimed.

First value before installation

Reconsidered the user journey: a BRET practice or a DM comparison can be tried in the browser without installation or registration. Defined the guest scope and prioritised a useful action. Guest web flows are available; activation and conversion impact still need measurement.

Web products and AI-agent workflows

Organised the move from Webflow to Hugo/JS and Cloudflare Pages, with history in Forgejo. Agent workflows use SDD/OpenSpec, bounded scope and functional checks. Develop team n8n/RAG tools for articles and courses. No measured savings, speed or conversion gains are claimed; PWA is planned.

Products | First value | Web and AI | Move to Hugo

Systems, teams & approach

WinLab: complex projects and stakeholder management

Flexible assortment matrix

The project aimed to expand regional assortments through local producers and create an opportunity for revenue growth. Discussions with the main stakeholder were tense. I temporarily paused direct communication with them, involved a wider group of stakeholders and heard other perspectives. We then brought leadership into the work. Together with the team, we moved the project to preparing business and functional requirements.

Checkout system and Kafka

Another project involved moving the checkout system from a monolith to microservices and Kafka. My task was to secure priority with contractor Kristall and keep the project on schedule. I challenged their project managers' position using project management practices and set out my next steps. Within a few hours, they accepted my position; the contractor prioritised the project.

1C reporting automation

The main challenge here was working with the business stakeholder. During one project meeting, the accounting team broke off the discussion and left. I had to use escalation. The project progressed during my engagement: a test launch took place before I left.

Read the case online

Kickidler: From team diagnosis to delivery changes

Context and my work

At Kickidler, I diagnosed delivery, requirements and collaboration problems. I introduced a roadmap, used RACI and MoSCoW, and prepared an analyst template and a change plan.

Results

Based on my assessment, LTV increased by 20% and TTM halved. There were fewer bugs; analytics, motivation and team eNPS improved. Comparison periods and TTM/LTV methods are not provided here. These are team results, not the effect of one recommendation.

Read the case online

Further experience & skills

Statistics & Control: Turning complex systems into manageable work

Context

Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS reverse engineering and scripts for equipment-version migrations. Later moved to OptiRamp, digital twins, forecasting and modelling for Russian and international clients. I managed projects with a combined value of approximately RUB 50 million per year. This describes project scale, not revenue attributed to my actions.

My role and actions

Coordinated the team and delivery; worked on requirements, risks and presales. Introduced Kanban, task evaluation, feedback and engineer onboarding processes. Prepared proposals for organisational transformation.

Consulting and analytical justification

In my 2022 HSE final project, developed an organisational transformation proposal: current and future reality trees, SWOT, a role model and pilot plan. Modelled costs, NPV and payback, and analysed schedule risks with Monte Carlo simulation in Primavera Risk Analysis. This is an assumption-based proposal and forecast, not verified savings.

Read the case online

Skills & tools

Product: product strategy, discovery, customer development, roadmap, prioritization, stakeholder management, Scrum/Kanban. Analytics and consulting: KPIs, LTV, business analysis, Current/Future Reality Trees, NPV. Team AI tools: n8n, LLM orchestration, hybrid RAG, PostgreSQL/PGVector. Practice: ClickHouse, Streamlit, ICONIX, PlantUML, SDD/OpenSpec, Git, Jira, Figma. Marketing and flows: behavioural marketing (Behavioral Marketing), Product Storytelling, activation and first-value journey design. Theoretical grounding: Storynomics and behavioural approaches by Fogg, Kahneman and Cialdini. Web products with AI agents: Hugo/JavaScript, Cloudflare Pages, Git/Forgejo.

Python: basic. Russian: native. English: B2+/C1 (self-assessed).

Education & learning

Peter the Great St Petersburg Polytechnic University - Technical education, master's studies · 2009-2015

HSE · Master in Management - Professional education programme, with distinction · 2021-2022

PMP / Certified ScrumMaster - PMI / Scrum Alliance · 2023

Machine Learning / Deep Learning - SkillFactory · 2022